

and “Most Likely to Succeed,” accolades that may hint at both the determination that I still can’t seem to shake and, perhaps, the entrepreneurial spirit that would later shape my career. I’ll never forget the inspiration that I received when in my junior year I read this sentence in Thomas Macaulay’s essay on Samuel Johnson: “The force of his mind overcame his every impediment.”

So my attitude to what’s enough in this life, I think, has been largely shaped by my heritage and the experiences of my youth, not least among them being blessed by a strong family: proud grandparents, loving parents, and a marvelous brotherhood of three who fought with each other but were united when others wanted to take us on.

That combination might well have led nowhere; after all, the Bogle boys were hardly worse off than countless numbers of other American youths. But as I reached toward maturity and ever after, I have been blessed with infinite good fortune in my life, often of miraculous dimension. Surely my first major break was when Blair Academy accepted the responsibility for my education. Without these breaks, who knows where I’d be (indeed, as you’ll soon learn, even *if* I’d be) today? I have come to refer to each turn of good fortune as akin to discovering a diamond. Over the course of my life, as it has turned out, I would discover “acres of diamonds.”

Acres of Diamonds

In ancient Persia, a wealthy farmer leaves his home to seek even greater wealth, and spends his life in a fruitless search for a perhaps mythical diamond mine. Finally, as age and years of frustration take their toll, he throws himself into the sea and dies, an unhappy pauper far from home. Meanwhile, back at his estate, the new owner, surveying his vast acreage, sees something in a stream, something bright, glistening in the sunlight. It is a large diamond, and turns out to rest atop the fabulous Golconda mine.